

Grant van Zyl

OPERATIONS · DIGITAL PRODUCTION · ADMINISTRATION · BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Exeter, United Kingdom · Open to new opportunities ·
linkedin.com/in/grantvanzyl · github.com/EricDarkomen

PROFILE

Operations and product professional with 25+ years across logistics, licensed consumer goods, compliance, data services and digital production. I bring order to complex environments and build processes from scratch – and the work I do best is the work where something gets made: product taken from concept to market, the content and copy around it, and the software itself. Technically adept across a broad range of platforms, from Adobe CC and AI development tools to SQL and Excel, with a proven record supporting business launches, continuous improvement programmes and multi-site operations.

EXPERIENCE

Nov 2025 – present
Exeter

Defleet Advisor

Switch / Thrifty – Scot Group Ltd

Vehicle rental group operating the Switch and Thrifty brands.

- Contact rental customers to arrange vehicle changeovers so units can come back for defleet.
- Process sales invoices for defleeted vehicles and reconcile them.
- Prepare vehicle title transfers and the associated DVLA paperwork.
- Maintain the key and V5 document store.

2020 – 2022
London Heathrow

Cargo Clerical Officer · CI Champion

IAG Cargo

Freight division of International Airlines Group – one of the world’s largest airline groups, handling millions of tonnes of cargo annually.

- Seconded to the Transformation department – facilitated Gemba Walks, led 5S implementations and ran 5-Why root cause analysis workshops.
- Validated and updated critical transit and customs documentation in a highly time-sensitive environment.
- Operated service desks providing direct customer support including warehouse deliveries and collections.

2007 – 2020
United Kingdom

Product Development · Digital Production · Data Services · IT

Grant and Bowman Ltd

Family-owned multinational product development and distribution group with interests in licensed consumer goods, ecommerce and digital retail.

- Developed licensed product from concept to market, working with high-profile rights holders.
- Produced digital marketing content, sales copy and branded materials; operated the ecommerce channels.
- Supported the launch and operation of Wham-O Europe, Laser Pegs Europe, Goldfish and Bison, and ToyDip.com – from inception through to establishment.
- Held global accountability for product compliance in a highly regulated consumer goods category.
- Oversaw multiple technology implementations and system migrations across the group.

2006 – 2007 London	Business Development Transfer 2000 – Contributed to the development of a new transport service. I left after the owner passed away; the business still trades.
2002 – 2005 London	Operations Management · Client Implementation TNT Express <i>Global logistics company acquired by FedEx in 2016. Progressed from clerk in Managed Services to consultancy and client implementation roles.</i> – Led and executed an 18-month modernisation project for Imperial College London. – Designed, launched and operated document imaging centres for Marsh McLennan / Guy Carpenter. – Developed add-on service products including a JIT sample store and fulfilment service for GlaxoSmithKline. – Provided day-to-day operations management to TNT and various corporate implant operations.
2000 – 2002 London	Agency and Temporary Roles Various clients – Office-based assignments across data, quality and business support while establishing myself in the UK.

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

DIGITAL PRODUCTION	Adobe Illustrator & Photoshop · product design · licensed brand materials · sales copy & marketing content
AI & GENERATIVE TOOLS	AI-assisted development (Claude, Copilot, Cursor) · generative image & content production · prompt engineering · workflow automation
DEVELOPMENT	HTML5 · CSS · JavaScript · C# · WordPress · Shopify · SharePoint · Unreal Engine · Unity
OPERATIONS	Multi-site management · project management · business launch & remediation · team training · process design
CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT	Six Sigma DMAIC · Lean 5S · 5-Why RCA · Gemba Walks · process documentation · work instruction authoring
DATA & ANALYSIS	MS Excel (lookups, pivots, Power Query, DAX) · SQL · relational database design · data visualisation
ADMINISTRATION	Invoicing · V5 & DVLA documentation · document control · records management · high-accuracy data entry
MICROSOFT OFFICE	Word · Excel · PowerPoint · Outlook · Visio – proficient across the full suite

EDUCATION & BACKGROUND

Studied Business in Cape Town, South Africa before relocating to the UK in 2000. Early career built a broad foundation across service, quality and administration roles in London.

INTERESTS

I’ve embraced AI as a creative and technical force multiplier. My personal projects now centre on AI-assisted development – using large language models and generative tools to accelerate code, build custom tooling and prototype ideas that would previously have taken far longer to reach a working state. Alongside this I produce AI-generated content across visual, written and interactive formats, exploring how these tools can be directed with intention and craft. It is a

space I find endlessly stimulating, and one where my background in digital production, design and development gives me a head start.

SELECTED PROJECTS

2025 – present

Personal

LeanOS

An operations suite for lean & operational excellence – browser-based, no server

Sixty-one connected tools covering what an operation runs on – the daily SQCDP board, 5S audits, OEE, SMED, value-stream maps, FMEA, 8D and A3 – wired to an order book, a stock ledger, payroll and a real set of books, so a number on the dashboard is one hop from the cause behind it. Roughly 84,000 lines, running entirely in the browser on an OPFS-backed SQLite engine: no account, no server, no data leaving the device.

- Private repository – available to walk through or demonstrate on request.

2025 – present

Personal

Call of Duty: Customer Service

A browser game in HTML, CSS and JavaScript – no dependencies, no build step

A call-centre role-playing game of roughly 28,000 lines, written from scratch and covered by twenty-three browser-driven test suites. It ships with its own level editor – ten document types behind one shell, running cross-file validation as you type – and a sprite build that enforces third-party asset licensing rather than trusting it.

- Playable at ericdarkomen.github.io/CallHall.